

PRD & Product Report

A complete product brief for the live multiplayer cricket guessing game: features, flows, architecture, case study, target customer, links, and roadmap.

LIVE WEB APP

REALTIME ROOMS

SOCIAL RESULTS



Guess The Cricketer

Create a room. Share a code.

1000

cricketers

2-10

players per room

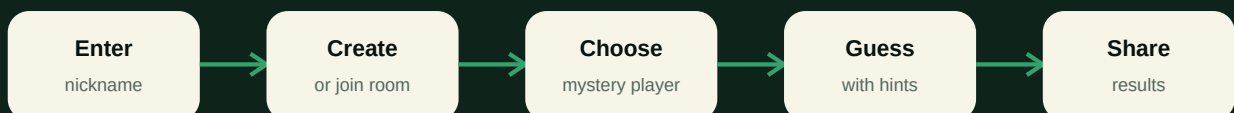
1-8

round settings

90s

turn timer

First-session user flow



Production

guessthecricketer.com

Repository

github.com/AshutoshSri123/guess-the-cricketer

Prepared

July 5, 2026

1. Executive Summary

Guess The Cricketer is a live multiplayer cricket guessing game where friends enter a shared room, rotate as clue-givers, select mystery cricketers, reveal structured hints, and compete on speed, accuracy, and clue quality.

1000 cricketers in database	15 national teams represented	2-10 players per room	90s turn timer	1-8 round settings
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The product is already deployed as a web application with custom domain, Render fallback domain, health endpoint, analytics, legal pages, and a production build pipeline from GitHub main.

Area	Current implementation	Product value
Core loop	Create/join/quick play room, choose player, reveal hints, guess, score, summarize.	Turns a familiar cricket trivia idea into a social party-game format.
Content	1000 cricketers, 71 teams, men and women categories, active/retired/legend statuses.	Supports replayability and wider fan coverage.
Fairness	Difficulty, time, hints, wrong guesses, solve rate, and clue quality influence points.	Reduces blind-guess exploits and rewards useful clue giving.
Shareability	Room code/link sharing plus final result image download/share.	Creates lightweight acquisition loops through friends and social posts.

2. Product Links And Ownership

Item	Link / value	Purpose
Production domain	https://guessthecricketer.com	Primary public web app.
Render fallback	https://guess-the-cricketer-hxe2.onrender.com	Fallback hosted domain.
Health check	https://guessthecricketer.com/health	Expected response: { "ok": true, "name": "guess-the-cricketer" }.
GitHub repository	https://github.com/AshutoshSri123/guess-the-cricketer . git	Source of truth and Render auto-deploy trigger from main.
Privacy	https://guessthecricketer.com/privacy	Privacy policy.
Terms	https://guessthecricketer.com/terms	Terms of use.
Contact	https://guessthecricketer.com/contact	Feedback and issue entry point.
Feedback email	guessthecricketer.feedback@gmail.com	Gmail compose links prefill feedback or issue reports.
Social image	https://guessthecricketer.com/brand/guess-the-cricketer-social-v2.png	Open Graph/Twitter preview asset.
Analytics ID	G-7F3RCVJF06	Default Google Analytics measurement ID.

3. Product Requirements Document

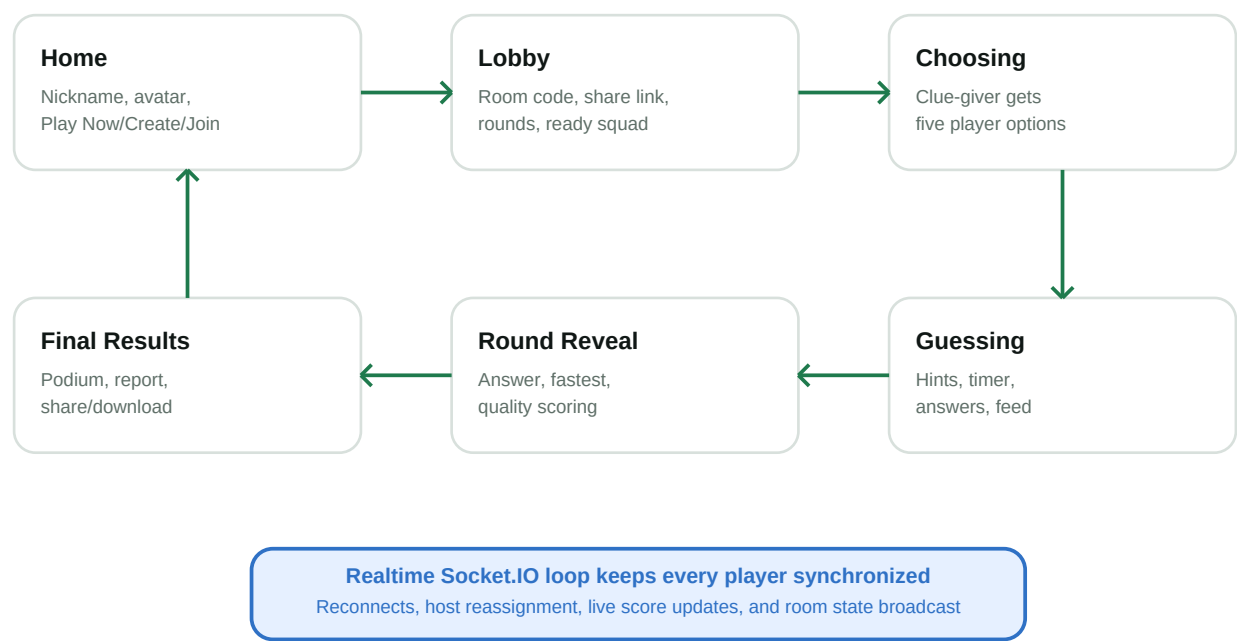
Field	Requirement
Vision	Become the easiest cricket party game to start from a phone browser: no install, no login, quick rooms, competitive rounds, and shareable results.
Problem	Cricket fans want social trivia experiences that feel live and cricket-native, but many quiz products are solo, static, or too generic.

Field	Requirement
Primary goal	Let 2-10 friends start a playable multiplayer cricket guessing match in under one minute.
Secondary goal	Create replayability through a broad player database, rotating clue-giver turns, scoring nuance, and result sharing.
Non-goal	The current product is not a gambling, fantasy, betting, or licensed cricket data product.
Platforms	Responsive web application for modern mobile and desktop browsers.
Success criteria	Room creation/join success, game starts, completed games, average players per room, repeat sessions, and shared/downloaded results.

Release state

- Live production domain and Render fallback are configured.
- Server exposes a health endpoint and production static client serving.
- Legal routes exist for privacy, terms, and contact/feedback.
- Google Analytics plus optional Plausible, PostHog, and Umami hooks are supported.

4. User Flow



The product has three entry modes. Play Now creates or joins a matchmaking room, Create Room starts a hosted room with configurable rounds, and Join Room accepts a shared five-character room code or room-link query parameter.

Step	User action	System behavior	Exit / next state
Home	Enter nickname, customize avatar, choose Play Now/Create/Join.	Validates nickname where needed and connects the Socket.IO client.	Lobby or matchmaking wait.
Lobby	Host copies code/link, configures rounds, starts match after at least two connected players.	Maintains connected player list, host badge, ready status, room capacity.	Choosing phase.
Choosing	Current clue-giver selects one of five cricketers.	Only clue-giver receives options; answer stays hidden from guessers.	Guessing phase with 90 second timer.
Guessing	Clue-giver reveals/skips hints; guessers submit full names.	Broadcasts hints/feed/score state; close guesses receive personal letter pattern.	Turn ends on all correct, timeout, or manual end.
Round reveal	Players review answer, fastest guesses, solve rate, and clue-giver score.	Computes fair scoring and round quality label.	Next turn or final results.
Final results	Players view podium, match report, download/share result image, or host starts rematch.	Ranks players by score and emits share/download poster.	Restart or leave.

5. Feature Inventory

Feature	What it does	Primary user
Nickname and avatar	Players enter a nickname up to 18 characters and customize avatar attributes.	All players
Play Now	Creates or joins a matchmaking room; guest nickname is generated if omitted.	Casual player

Feature	What it does	Primary user
Create room	Creates a private room with five-character code and 1-8 round setting.	Host
Join room	Joins by room code; room links carry ?room=CODE.	Invited player
Host controls	Host configures rounds, starts match, restarts game, and can end turns.	Host
Clue-giver rotation	Connected players take turns selecting the mystery cricketer.	All players
Five-player selection	Clue-giver picks from five generated options while guessers wait.	Clue-giver
Hint board	Sequential hints include category, national team, role, career, batting, bowling, franchise, and final custom hint.	All players
Skip hint	Clue-giver can skip a hint slot; skipped hints do not reveal clue content.	Clue-giver
Custom final hint	A 20-character final hint is allowed after structured hints.	Clue-giver
Hint safety	Custom hint cannot contain the answer, aliases, or obvious initials.	All players
Guess input	Guessers submit names up to 60 characters; clue-giver cannot guess.	Guessers
Close guess feedback	Near misses trigger 'very close' feedback and personal answer-letter pattern.	Guessers
Realtime feed	System events, guesses, and correct solves show in-room.	All players
Leaderboard	Live score, host, clue-giver, and got-it badges display during play.	All players
Timer ring	Shows 90 second turn countdown with warning/danger states.	All players
Round reveal	Shows answer, winners, points, solve rate, hints used, clue-giver delta, and quality reason.	All players
Fair scoring	Scores use difficulty, time, hint usage, field size, rank, wrong guesses, and integrity caps.	All players
Final standings	Match report, podium, score stats, and winner dominance are shown.	All players
Share/download results	Exports a 1080x1920 result poster for sharing or download.	All players
Reconnect support	Stable tab player ID reconnects users to active room and clue options.	All players
Host reassignment	If host leaves, another player becomes host.	Remaining players
Issue reporting	Prefilled Gmail compose includes room code, phase, round, nickname, player ID, and URL.	All players
Legal pages	Privacy, terms, and contact routes are available from home.	Visitors

6. Game Mechanics And Scoring

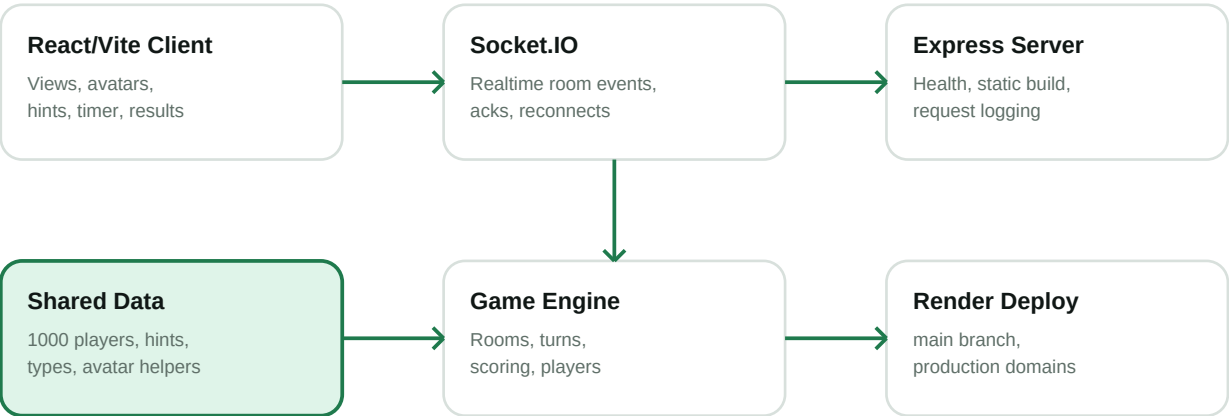
The game loop is designed so both guessers and clue-givers can earn points. Guessers are rewarded for speed and accuracy, while clue-givers are rewarded when their clues create a balanced, solvable round.

Mechanic	Implementation detail	Product reason
Player options	Five options are selected while avoiding already shown/used player IDs where possible.	Reduces repetition and keeps the clue-giver choice fresh.
Hints	Available hint slots adapt to player data; unknown bat/bowling values and empty franchise teams are omitted.	Prevents low-quality hint slots.
Correctness	Guess is normalized and must equal official player name.	Keeps the game clear and avoids ambiguous partial matches.
Near misses	Levenshtein distance against name and aliases determines close guesses.	Helps players recover from typos without giving away the full answer.
Personal pattern	Wrong guesses can reveal same-position letters only to that guesser.	Adds feedback while preserving room-wide mystery.
Guess points	Difficulty, remaining time, hints before correct, field size, solve rank, wrong guesses, and blind-guess caps shape points.	Rewards quality guessing and discourages spam.
Clue points	Clue-giver receives score from total guesser points plus difficulty and round quality multiplier.	Rewards helpful clue pacing, not just obscure picks.
Round quality	Labels include Balanced, Too easy, Too hard, and Low information.	Makes scoring transparent and teaches better clue-giving.
Auto end	Turn ends when all eligible guessers solve, when timer expires, or when host/clue-giver ends manually.	Keeps session pacing tight.

7. Content And Data Model

1000 players	71 teams	870 men	130 women	88 legends
Entity	Important fields	Notes		
CricketPlayer	id, name, aliases, nationality, role, battingStyle, bowlingStyle, teams, gender, status, difficulty, tags	Shared content object used by client and server.		
PublicRoomState	code, phase, hostId, players, settings, turn, turnSummary, messages, winnerIds	Client-safe state broadcast to all players.		
TurnState	clueGiverId, round, totalRounds, startedAt, endsAt, pattern, hint keys, revealed hints, correct guessers	Options and selected answer are intentionally hidden from public state.		
TurnSummary	answer, clueGiverName, reason, scoring, correctGuessers	Powers the round reveal and scoring explanation.		
PublicPlayer	nickname, avatarStyle, score, correctGuesses, host/connected/guessed flags	Supports scoreboard and lobby state.		

8. Technical Architecture



Layer	Technology	Responsibilities
Client	React 19, Vite 6, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, lucide-react, html-to-image	Responsive UI, room interactions, avatar rendering, audio feedback, result poster export, analytics.
Server	Express 5, Socket.IO 4, TypeScript/tsx	HTTP health/static serving, realtime game rooms, matchmaking, timers, scoring, reconnects, host reassignment.
Shared	TypeScript shared modules and generated JSON	Player database, game logic, scoring helpers, avatars, strongly typed Socket.IO events.
Deploy	GitHub main to Render	Push to main triggers production deployment.
Observability	Health endpoint, console JSON request logs, analytics events	Uptime checks, basic request diagnostics, product funnel tracking.

9. Target Customer

Segment	Profile	Needs	Why this product fits
Primary	Cricket fans aged 13-35 who play with friends on mobile during calls, watch parties, school/college breaks, or group chats.	Fast start, low friction, familiar players, friendly competition.	No login/install, shareable room link, lively real-time loop.
Secondary	Content creators, fan-page admins, cricket communities, Discord/WhatsApp groups.	Interactive community game that creates shareable moments.	Result poster and multiplayer rooms support social engagement.
Tertiary	Families and casual fans who know popular players but not deep stats.	Simple rules, clues that educate, mixed difficulty.	Hints expose country, role, style, career, and franchise information.

Persona

Name	Context	Motivations	Pain points
Arjun, 21	College cricket fan in a WhatsApp group during IPL nights.	Wants a quick competitive game friends can join from phones.	Hates account creation, stale question banks, and games where one person dominates without social banter.
Sara, 28	Runs a cricket fan community.	Needs lightweight live activities between matches.	Needs shareable outcomes and simple moderation/reporting paths.

10. Full Case Study

Scenario

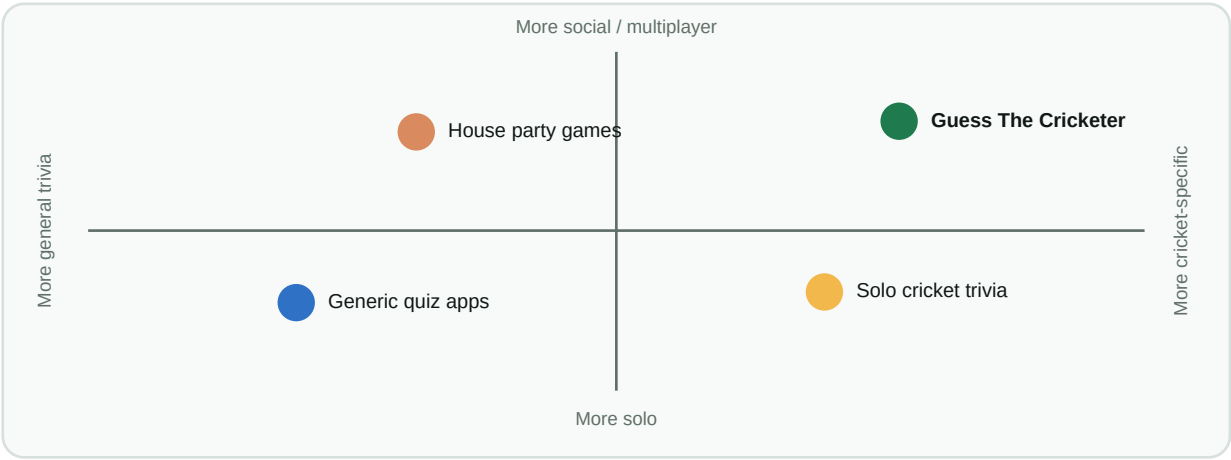
A group of six friends are watching a T20 match. During the innings break, one player opens the site, enters a nickname, creates a room, copies the link, and shares it in the group chat. Everyone joins from mobile browsers.

Moment	User behavior	Product response	Outcome
Setup	Host selects 3 rounds and starts after six players join.	Lobby shows room code, share link, squad, host badge, and round setting.	Game starts without accounts or installs.
Round 1	Clue-giver picks a medium-difficulty player and reveals category, country, and role.	Guessers see answer pattern and hints while timer counts down.	Two players solve quickly, one near-miss gets personal pattern.
Round reveal	Players compare fastest answers and clue score.	Reveal explains solve rate, hints used, clue-giver delta, and quality label.	Players understand why points were awarded.
Mid-game	One player disconnects briefly and returns.	Stable client ID reconnects the player to the room.	The session continues with minimal disruption.
Final	Winner downloads the result poster and shares it.	Final standings show podium, match stats, and share/download buttons.	The group has a social artifact that can bring others into the next game.

Business implication

- The fastest acquisition path is friend-to-friend sharing through room links and final result posters.
- Replayability depends on player database quality, balanced hint flow, and fair scoring transparency.
- A future community-growth path could add themed packs, public rooms, creator-hosted tournaments, and persistent profiles.

11. Market Positioning



Positioning statement	Evidence in product
For cricket fans who want a fast live party game, Guess The Cricketer is a browser-based multiplayer guessing game that turns cricket knowledge into shared rounds, clues, and result stories.	Room codes, realtime Socket.IO state, broad cricketer database, hint controls, fair scoring, and shareable final posters.
Differentiation	Cricket-specific clue taxonomy, clue-giver rotation, answer pattern feedback, and scoring that values both guessing and clue quality.
Tone	Friendly, competitive, social, mobile-first, cricket-native.

12. Analytics And Measurement

Event	When it fires	Why it matters
page_visit	App loads.	Top-of-funnel visits.
room_created	Create Room succeeds.	Hosted-room intent.
room_joined	Join Room succeeds.	Invite flow success.
quick_play_joined	Play Now succeeds.	Matchmaking demand.
game_started	Host starts game.	Activation.
game_completed	Room reaches ended phase.	Core loop completion.
room_link_copied	User copies share link.	Invite/share intent.
room_code_copied	User copies room code.	Invite/share intent.
disconnect	Socket disconnects.	Reliability monitoring.
socket_error	Connection/action errors.	Friction and failure diagnostics.
report_issue	User opens issue email.	Support/contact engagement.
legal_page_view	Privacy/terms/contact route viewed.	Trust/compliance surface usage.

Recommended north-star metric

Completed multiplayer matches per week, segmented by average players per room and share-link source.

Recommended supporting metrics

- Visitor to room-created/joined conversion.
- Room-created to game-started conversion.
- Game-started to game-completed conversion.
- Average players per room and average rounds completed.
- Share link copies per completed game.
- Disconnects/errors per active game.

13. Risks, Constraints, And Open Questions

Risk / question	Impact	Recommended mitigation
No persistent accounts	Lower retention visibility and no cross-session identity.	Add optional lightweight profiles only after core viral loop proves demand.
In-memory rooms	Rooms disappear on server restart and do not scale horizontally without shared state.	Introduce Redis or managed realtime state before large public-room growth.
Content correctness	Wrong player data can frustrate cricket fans.	Add feedback workflow for player corrections and content review queue.
Abuse moderation	Nicknames/custom hints could be offensive despite current constraints.	Add profanity filter and room host kick/moderation controls.
Licensing/branding	Cricket player/team references and logos may need review depending on commercial ambitions.	Audit assets and replace risky logos with generic marks if needed.

Risk / question	Impact	Recommended mitigation
Analytics privacy	Analytics and logs include device/browser/network-derived context.	Keep privacy copy current and minimize personally identifying data.

14. Recommended Roadmap

Phase	Initiatives	Expected impact
Now	QA mobile flows, improve content correction loop, add basic moderation filter, add deploy-status checklist.	Reduce friction and trust risks.
Next	Themed packs, daily challenge, public lobby discovery, creator room templates.	Increase replayability and organic growth.
Later	Persistent profiles, achievements, season leaderboards, tournaments, Redis-backed room state.	Build retention and scalable competitive play.

15. Appendix: Production Checklist

Checklist item	Current evidence
Custom domain	https://guessthecricketer.com
Fallback domain	https://guess-the-cricketer-hxe2.onrender.com
Health endpoint	GET /health returns product health JSON.
SEO metadata	Canonical URL, Open Graph, Twitter card, schema.org WebApplication, sitemap, robots, web manifest.
Deployment	Render auto-deploy from GitHub main branch.
Validation commands	npm test and npm run build before code/content commits; docs-only changes may skip with note.

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